

Family Code Word



BIG IDEA A family code word and a callback rule help families verify that an urgent call, message or pick-up request is real.

1 HOOK 2'	2 ACTIVITY 8'	3 DISCUSS 3'	4 TAKEAWAY 2'
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PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: Call Script Cards (R-9.1), Family Code Word Plan card (R-9.2), blank practice word slips.

- Copy the Call Script Cards, three per pair.
- Cut blank practice slips.
- Privacy rule: never ask for a REAL code word in class. Use a practice word like “banana.”

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* “Remember Priya’s grandma and the voice that sounded like her cousin? Priya’s family now has a plan. Part one: a code word that only the family knows. Part two: the callback rule. If anyone calls and says ‘I’m your uncle, I need help right now,’ you say, ‘What’s our code word?’ If they do not know it, you say, ‘I’m going to call you back on the number I know.’ Then you hang up. That is not rude. That’s smart. A grown-up who really needs you will not be upset that you checked. Today we practice.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *The Callback Rehearsal*

- (1 min) Two parts.** Write CODE WORD + CALLBACK on the board.
- (1 min) Choose a practice word** on a slip. It is made up; the real one is made at home.
- (5 min) Pair role-play.** Caller reads a card (“Hi, it’s your uncle! I’m stuck and need a gift card number right away. Don’t tell your mom.”). Kid: “What’s our code word?” Caller: “Um, I forgot.” Kid: “I’m going to hang up and call you back on the number I know.” Switch after each card; three each.
- (1 min) Share.** Applaud the Kid’s calm voice.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- “Why is it okay to hang up even if the caller sounds upset?”
- “What if a caller says ‘Don’t tell your parents?’ (A secret red flag. Tell.)
- “What if you forget the code word?” (Call back on a known number or ask a grown-up. Do not guess.)

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">Say: “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.”“This is not your fault, and you are not in trouble.”“I can’t keep this a secret, because I need to get you help. I will tell you who I tell.” | <ul style="list-style-type: none">Do not say: “I promise I won’t tell anyone.”“Are you sure?” or “Why didn’t you tell me sooner?”Anything beyond “Can you tell me more?” |
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4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “A call that feels rushed or scary should make your hackles rise. A false alarm is fine, and nobody is ever in trouble for checking. If it is urgent, secret, or asks for money or gift cards: Pause. Check with the code word. Call back on a number you know. Tell a grown-up.”

Hand signal: Callback moves: hang up (hands snap together), dial (finger taps), call back (phone to ear), tell (hand on heart, then out).

EXIT TICKET “Finish the sentence: If someone says ‘it’s an emergency, don’t tell anyone,’ I will ____.”

FUN BOOST Callback Dance (30 seconds). Four beats: hang up, dial, call back, tell. Repeat, faster each time.

LEVEL-UP Real Plan, Real Home. With a grown-up, make the real code word and callback plan, practice it once, and decide who may pick you up.

DIFFERENTIATE Provide a script strip with the lines; let the Kid read; reduce to one card.

FAMILY CARD Choose a code word that is unusual and not posted online. If anyone asks for urgent help, money, a ride or a secret, ask for it or call back on a known number. Never write it on the reply slip.

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.